

Swimming Pool & Spa Barriers



Barriers are assessed to AS 1926.1. These are the items that decide it, and what your plans must show.

THE NUMBERS THAT GET CHECKED EVERY TIME

Barrier height	Minimum 1200 mm , measured on the outside (approach side), anywhere along the barrier.
Gap under the barrier	No more than 100 mm from finished ground.
Non-climbable zone	A 900 mm quadrant on the outside of the barrier clear of footholds — no horizontal rails, retaining, planters, BBQs or trees inside it.
Gates	Self-closing and self-latching from any position, opening away from the pool, latch release at least 1500 mm above ground (or internally shielded).
Boundary fence as barrier	Effective height on the <i>inside</i> of at least 1800 mm , with the non-climbable zone on the inside face.
Windows & doors	Doors can't form part of the barrier for a new pool; openable windows into the pool area are restricted (limited opening or screened).

WHAT THE SITE PLAN MUST SHOW

- ✓ The **barrier line** drawn right around the pool zone — fences, walls, gates, and which existing fences are being relied on.
- ✓ **Gate positions and swing direction.**
- ✓ **Heights** of every barrier element, including existing boundary fences being relied on.
- ✓ Anything inside the non-climbable zones — retaining, equipment, landscaping — so we can see it's clear.
- ✓ The pool or spa itself dimensioned to boundaries, with the engineering or manufacturer's specification attached.

The common bounce: a compliant fence with a climbable object beside it — a retaining wall, a raised planter, the filter box. Walk the barrier line on the plan and ask "could a five-year-old use this?" That's the assessment.

AFTER THE PERMIT

Pool barriers stay a permanent obligation, not a one-off: your local government inspects them on an ongoing cycle (at least once every four years in WA). Keep the barrier compliant as landscaping and fences change.

